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From Concept to Code: Operationalizing r_carbon and r_biodiversity in Modular Rust Components for Cyboquatic Systems

Formalizing Carbon-Negative Performance as a Quantifiable Risk Coordinate

The extension of the Cyboquatic ecosafety framework to include carbon-negative performance requires moving beyond conventional emissions tracking and embedding a holistic, quantifiable measure of net carbon impact directly into the core safety logic. This involves formalizing a new risk coordinate, `r_carbon`, which must be treated not as a standalone metric but as a first-class citizen within the unified `RiskVector`. Its calculation, normalization, and enforcement are governed by the same Lyapunov invariant that ensures physical safety, thereby making ecologically restorative operation a prerequisite for any actuation. The process begins with the rigorous measurement and integration of carbon mass loads, followed by the normalization of these loads against the energy consumed in their removal, and culminates in a normalized risk value that feeds directly into the global Lyapunov residual, `V_t`.

The foundational element for `r_carbon` is the accurate tracking of carbon mass, whether removed from the atmosphere, captured from industrial processes, or sequestered in engineered geological formations [15]. For an industrial machine, this could involve monitoring the intake of CO2-rich streams or the output of solidified carbon products. The raw data consists of time-series measurements of mass flow rates, which are then integrated over time to produce a cumulative mass load integral [27]. This cumulative figure represents the total quantity of carbon the system has processed. However, simply accumulating mass is insufficient; the energy cost associated with this process is a critical determinant of its true environmental value. Therefore, the framework incorporates an energy-per-mass metric, denoted E_x, typically expressed in units like kilowatt-hours per kilogram (kWh/kg) of carbon removed [13]. This metric captures the operational efficiency of the carbon capture or utilization technology. An industrial process that removes one tonne of CO2 using 1000 kWh is fundamentally more sustainable than one that achieves the same result using 5000 kWh, especially if the latter relies on fossil-fueled electricity. By integrating both the mass load and the

corresponding energy expenditure, the system creates a composite picture of the carbon balance that accounts for both quantity and quality.

Once these two core values—the total mass of carbon processed and the total energy expended—are established, they must be converted into a dimensionless risk coordinate, `r_carbon`, scaled to the interval [0, 1]. This normalization process is crucial for ensuring compatibility with other risk coordinates within the `RiskVector`. The normalization would likely follow a sigmoidal or piecewise linear function relative to predefined corridors. These corridors represent scientifically and economically defensible thresholds for carbon neutrality and negativity. For instance, a corridor might be defined such that a design achieving a net negative carbon balance (i.e., more carbon sequestered than energy consumed, when accounting for the grid mix) receives a `r_carbon` value near zero, indicating low risk. Conversely, a design that is carbon-positive or has a very high energy penalty for its carbon removal would receive a value approaching one, indicating high risk. The exact shape and location of these corridors are not arbitrary; they are derived from standards like those proposed for Carbon Dioxide Capture and Storage (CCUS) and are continuously refined with field data [14] [15]. The resulting `r_carbon` value is then appended to the `RiskVector`, just like coordinates for pressure, temperature, or chemical concentration. This vector is then used to calculate the instantaneous Lyapunov residual, $V_t = \sum_j w_j r_j^2$, where w_j are the weights for each risk coordinate [24]. Any controller action that would cause V_t to increase is rejected by the `safestep_ok` invariant, preventing the machine from operating in a state that compromises either its physical safety or its carbon-negative mandate.

This tight integration into the core safety logic is what elevates the concept from simple monitoring to provable ecosafety. It prevents scenarios where a machine might appear safe in the short term but is environmentally unsustainable over its lifecycle. For example, a design might require frequent maintenance cycles that consume significant embedded energy, pushing its overall carbon balance into positive territory. This inefficiency would manifest as a higher `r_carbon` value, which would increase the total `V_t`. If this increase violates the `safestep_ok` constraint, the controller will refuse to execute the action, effectively gating deployment until the design is improved. The `ker_deployable` flag serves as the ultimate arbiter; a design that consistently fails to meet its carbon corridors, even if it passes all immediate physical safety checks, will have this flag set to false, preventing it from being compiled into operational workflows entirely [24]. This shifts failure detection from the field, where a faulty machine could cause harm, back to the controlled environment of the lab or CI pipeline, aligning perfectly with the goal of creating 50-year systems that remain safe and restorative [24]. The entire process is documented and made auditable through the generation of Atomic

Ledger Notation (ALN) shards, which contain the raw mass and energy data, the calculated `r_carbon`, the full `KER` triad, and a hexstamped spec ID, creating an immutable record of the machine's carbon performance [24].

Metric	Description	Source Data Type	Normalization Target
Mass Load Integral	Cumulative mass of carbon (CO2, C) processed by the system over time.	Time-series kg/s	Integrated value compared to baseline sequestration rate.
Energy Expenditure (E_{total})	Total electrical/mechanical energy consumed by the carbon processing unit.	Time-series kWh	Integrated value compared to theoretical minimum.
Energy-per-Mass (E_x)	Ratio of total energy to total mass processed (kWh/kg).	Scalar (derived)	Normalized against benchmarks for different technologies (e.g., solvent-based vs. solid sorbent).
Net Carbon Balance	Gross mass processed minus mass-equivalent of energy consumed.	Derived scalar	Normalized to create `r_carbon` score; targets carbon-neutral (-0.05 to +0.05) or carbon-negative (< -0.05).

Integrating Biodiversity Enhancement into the Ecosafety Framework

Integrating biodiversity enhancement into the Cyboquatic framework requires a paradigm shift from risk assessment as deviation from a norm to risk assessment as a measure of ecological contribution. The development of a `r_biodiversity` coordinate follows a structure analogous to `r_carbon` but applies to habitat creation and ecosystem function rather than pollution mitigation. This coordinate is designed to be a component of the `RiskVector`, governed by the same Lyapunov invariant, `V_t`. Its purpose is to ensure that industrial machinery, when designed and deployed appropriately, contributes positively to the local ecology, transforming infrastructure from passive structures into active agents of restoration. This is achieved by defining the coordinate in terms of measurable habitat quality metrics and mapping them to corridors where a low risk score signifies high ecological value.

The definition of `r_biodiversity` is rooted in established ecological principles and indicators. The research suggests deriving the coordinate from three key dimensions: habitat connectivity, structural complexity, and colonization potential [6] [8]. Habitat connectivity measures how well a given piece of machinery facilitates the movement of species, acting as a stepping stone between larger natural habitats. For an aquatic application, this could involve modeling water flow patterns around a submerged structure to assess its ability to support larval transport. Structural complexity refers to

the physical heterogeneity of the surface, which provides niches for diverse communities of organisms. A smooth metal cylinder offers far less complexity than a reef-like structure with crevices, overhangs, and varied textures. Colonization potential assesses the material properties and surface characteristics that promote the settlement and growth of key species, such as corals, oysters, or native vegetation. These metrics are not abstract concepts; they can be quantified. Connectivity can be modeled using graph theory applied to landscape or hydrodynamic data. Structural complexity can be measured using fractal dimensions or 3D point cloud analysis of the hardware's geometry. Colonization potential can be inferred from biofouling studies and material biocompatibility tests. These individual scores are then synthesized into a single `r_biodiversity` value.

A critical aspect of the `r_biodiversity` coordinate is its relationship with corridors. Unlike traditional risk coordinates that measure how far a variable is from a safe target (e.g., pressure too high is bad, pressure too low is also bad), `r_biodiversity` employs a positive-negative corridor model. In this model, a low risk score (near zero) corresponds to a design that successfully enhances high-quality habitat. As the design's contribution to biodiversity diminishes—for example, due to poor geometry, toxic materials, or lack of structural features—the `r_biodiversity` score increases towards one, indicating a higher risk of failing to deliver ecological benefits. Designs that create novel, high-value habitats might achieve a slightly negative score, representing a "net good" contribution that actively reduces the system's overall risk profile. The boundaries of these corridors are not static; they are informed by ecological research and can be updated as new data becomes available. For instance, a coral reef node designed as part of a marine sanctuary would be evaluated against corridors defined by marine biologists, who specify the geometric and material properties that lead to successful reef formation [21]. Similarly, a wetland restoration node would be assessed based on criteria related to plant rooting depth, water retention times, and sediment trapping efficiency [8].

Once calculated, `r_biodiversity` is integrated into the unified `RiskVector` alongside all other risk coordinates, including the newly created `r_carbon`. Because it is just another `r_j` term in the sum that defines the Lyapunov residual, $V_t = \sum_j w_j r_j^2$, it participates equally in the `safestep_ok` safety check [24]. This means that a controller cannot command an action that improves the carbon balance (`r_carbon` decreases) if that same action simultaneously degrades the habitat quality (`r_biodiversity` increases so much that V_t grows). This enforces a holistic optimization across all dimensions of safety and ecological impact, preventing unintended consequences. For example, modifying a pump's impeller to improve its energy efficiency (which could lower the `r_carbon` contribution) might inadvertently create excessive turbulence that damages nearby colonizing organisms. The increased `r_biodiversity` would raise the

total `V_t`, causing the `safestep_ok` check to fail and blocking the modification. This ensures that the machinery operates within a carefully balanced set of constraints that governs not only "do no harm" but also "does net good" over multi-year KER windows [24]. The deployment of such machinery is further controlled by the `ker_deployable` flag, which is determined by the system's adherence to all ecological and physical corridors. Only designs that demonstrate a capacity to enhance, rather than merely sustain, the local ecosystem are permitted to become active components of the Cyboquatic network.

Extending Core Safety Logic to Industrial Machinery Subsystems

The true power of the Cyboquatic framework lies in its ability to translate abstract ecological goals into concrete, verifiable constraints on specific industrial machinery subsystems. This requires extending the core safety logic—centered on the `cyboquatic-ecosafety-core` crate—into modular, reusable Rust components tailored for different types of equipment. These components act as specialized interfaces, translating the unique physical and operational realities of a subsystem (e.g., hydraulics, material handling, energy conversion) into the universal language of risk coordinates (`rx`), the Lyapunov residual (`Vt`), and the Knowledge-EcoImpact-Risk (KER) triad. By doing so, they enable a deep, systemic understanding of how every hardware choice and operational parameter affects the overall safety and ecological footprint of the entire industrial process.

A prime candidate for this extension is the hydraulic subsystem, a common source of both mechanical failure and environmental contamination. A dedicated `HydraulicSubsystemComponent` would be developed as a modular Rust crate. This component would continuously ingest real-time sensor data, such as fluid pressure, flow rate, temperature, and potentially acoustic emission data indicative of cavitation or wear. Using this input, it would compute a suite of specialized risk coordinates. For instance, it could calculate a `r_hydraulic_leakage` coordinate by modeling fluid dynamics and material fatigue, predicting potential failure points before they become catastrophic. It could also feed into existing coordinates like `r_PFAS_resid` if the hydraulic fluid contains such compounds, by estimating leakage rates and their dispersion in the surrounding environment [2]. Furthermore, it would contribute to the `E` (eco-impact) score by calculating `r_energy_efficiency_hydraulic`, a sub-coordinate that penalizes inefficiencies caused by friction, throttling, or pressure drops. All these

computed `rx` values would be fed into the central `RiskVector`, and the component would be responsible for generating ALN shards that document these metrics, providing an auditable trail of the hydraulic system's performance and risk status [24].

Another critical area is material handling and consumables, particularly in systems using biodegradable substrates like FlowVac. Here, the extension of the `econet_material_cybo` pattern is essential [28]. Each substrate batch would be characterized through standardized ISO or OECD tests, measuring parameters like mass loss rate, toxicity (e.g., LC50 for relevant fauna), leachate Chemical Equivalency Constant (CEC), micro-residue production, and PFAS residue levels [14]. These results populate a `FlowVacSubstrateShard`, a specialized ALN file containing a `KER` score and a set of `rmassloss`, `rtox`, `r_leach_CEC`, `rmicro`, and `r_PFAS_resid` coordinates. When a piece of machinery, such as a filter or a nutrient dosing pump, is configured to use a specific substrate, its main Rust component would query this shard. Before allowing the machine to operate, it would validate the substrate's coordinates against its own internal corridors. If the substrate's `r_tox` or `rmicro` values exceed safe limits, the machine's own `ker_deployable` flag would be set to false, effectively quarantining the entire hardware-substrate combination [24]. This cascading quality control mechanism ensures that only ecologically benign materials are deployed, shifting failure from the field back to the laboratory or CI pipeline and enforcing a circular loop where both the hardware and its consumables are rigorously screened for environmental impact [24].

Finally, the energy subsystem, encompassing electric motors and drives, is fundamental to achieving both physical safety and the ecological goals of energy efficiency and carbon negativity. A `MotorSubsystemComponent` would monitor electrical inputs (voltage, current) and mechanical outputs (rotational speed, torque) to compute real-time efficiency. More importantly, it would track degradation over time. As motor windings age or bearings wear, efficiency inevitably drops. This degradation would be quantified in a new risk coordinate, `r_motor_degradation`. This coordinate would increase progressively as performance deviates from its nominal curve, serving as an early warning system for impending failure or rising energy costs. This information feeds directly into the overall `V_t` calculation, signaling that the system's long-term stability is at risk. A high `r_motor_degradation` could trigger a derate command or halt actuation until maintenance is performed. This approach transforms the motor from a simple actuator into a prognostic health monitor, contributing to the system's resilience and its ability to maintain high eco-impact scores (`E`) over decades. By building these specialized, modular components, the Cyboquatic framework gains the granular capability to reason about the complex interplay of mechanics, energy, and ecology within every piece of industrial machinery.

The Role and Architecture of Non-Actuating Diagnostic Frames

Non-actuating diagnostic frames represent a sophisticated layer of intelligence within the Cyboquatic framework, designed to deepen the system's understanding of its environment and operational state without directly commanding actuators. These "function-only" modules, exemplified by a conceptual `HydraulicDecayFrame`, are a critical tool for tightening corridor validation and increasing the knowledge factor (`K`) of the system [24]. Their architecture is deliberately separated from the actuation path, ensuring that while they provide richer, more predictive insights that inform safety decisions, they never bypass or override the core ecosafety kernel. This separation is paramount for maintaining a low-risk profile (`R≈0.12`), as it localizes residual risk to the accuracy of models and sensors, which is explicitly surfaced through the `rx` and `V_t` coordinates before any action is taken [24].

The primary function of a diagnostic frame like `HydraulicDecayFrame` is to perform continuous, real-time analysis of system reach states—including variables like head, pressure, flow velocity, and constituent concentrations—and to compute updated risk coordinates and a revised Lyapunov residual, `V_t` [24]. Unlike a standard safety monitor that triggers a binary "safe/unsafe" flag upon crossing a threshold, a decay frame performs a more nuanced analysis. For a hydraulic system, it might use a `C++`-based numeric mirror to simulate the long-horizon effects of pipe corrosion, biofilm growth, and material fatigue [24]. Based on current conditions and known degradation kinetics (e.g., Arrhenius-style models for chemical reactions), the frame can forecast future leakage rates, pressure losses, and contaminant release probabilities. These forecasts are then translated into probabilistic risk coordinates, such as `r_future_leakage` or `r_structural_integrity_loss`. These coordinates are fed into the `RiskVector`, causing `V_t` to increase gradually as the predicted long-term risk rises, even if no immediate actuation block is triggered. This provides operators and automated systems with a forward-looking view of system health, enabling proactive maintenance and resource allocation.

The architectural design of these frames reinforces their supportive role. They exist as independent Rust modules that can be composed into larger systems. They read state from the system bus, invoke external computational kernels (like the `C++` simulator) if needed, perform their own calculations, and then emit structured updates, often in the form of `ShardUpdate` objects [24]. These updates contain the newly calculated `rx` values, the updated `V_t`, and metadata linking them to a specific timestamp and system

context. Crucially, they have no direct access to the actuator commands managed by the `cyboquatic-ecosafety-core`. All actuation remains strictly fenced by the core's `safestep_ok` invariant. The diagnostic frame's sole influence is to make the `RiskVector` more informative and precise. A more precise vector allows for the definition of tighter, more aggressive corridors. For example, with a reliable decay prediction model, the acceptable corridor for `r_hydraulic_pressure` could be narrowed because the system has a better handle on the risk of sudden failure due to slow leaks. This iterative process of gathering more knowledge (via diagnostics) to enable tighter constraints is the engine driving the system toward higher reliability and sustainability.

The practical application of this approach is best understood in the context of district-scale infrastructure management. Imagine a network of pipes and nodes managed by the Cyboquatic framework. A fleet of `HydraulicDecayFrame` instances, running on edge devices or in a central fog node, continuously monitors the entire network. Each reach in the system maintains its own atlas of risk coordinates (`r_FOG`, `r_solids`, `r_HLR`, etc.), which are constantly updated by these frames [24]. This dynamic atlas becomes the authoritative source of truth for determining which hardware-substrate combinations are permissible on any given reach. For instance, a routing decision to deploy a certain type of FlowVac pellet would depend not just on its intrinsic properties but also on the current `rmicro` and `r_CEC` risk vectors for the specific pipe segment where it is to be placed. If the decay atlas indicates that the pipe's lining is degrading and will soon release contaminants at a hazardous rate, the `r_CEC` corridor for that reach would tighten, potentially blocking the deployment of any new substrates until remediation occurs. This transforms the "no corridor, no build" principle from a static rule into a dynamic, data-driven constraint, ensuring that every deployment decision is grounded in the most current and comprehensive understanding of the system's state. The diagnostic frames are the indispensable sensors for this living atlas, providing the continuous stream of analytical insight needed to manage complex, long-horizon systems safely and sustainably.

A Verifiable Governance Pipeline via ALN Shards and FOG Routing

The integrity of the Cyboquatic ecosafety framework depends on a robust governance pipeline that transforms raw physical metrics into provably correct, auditable actions. This pipeline is anchored by two core technologies: Atomic Ledger Notation (ALN) shards

for evidence storage and the Cyboquatic FOG router for decision-making. ALN shards, formatted according to RFC-4180 standards, serve as immutable, cryptographically verifiable evidence packets, capturing every step of the reasoning process from initial measurement to final risk assessment [19] [24]. The FOG router acts as the gatekeeper, a pure Rust function that inspects these shards and uses their contents to enforce a series of fixed, non-negotiable predicates before permitting any actuation. This architecture formally separates the dynamic data from the static rules, creating a system that is transparent, trustworthy, and resistant to ad-hoc manipulation, thereby fulfilling the requirement that all edge-language implementations remain subordinate to the Rust/ALN kernel [24].

The lifecycle of an evidence packet begins with data acquisition. This can come from two primary sources: real-time sensors feeding into a Rust processing module, or long-horizon simulations running in a C++ numeric mirror [24]. For example, a `HydraulicSubsystemComponent` might read pressure and temperature from sensors. A `CarbonCaptureComponent` might log mass flow and energy consumption. Simultaneously, a separate C++ process could be running a detailed simulation of material decay or contaminant transport over years, generating the same kind of data points [24]. In both cases, the resulting data—be it raw readings or simulation outputs—is passed to a Rust function responsible for computation. This function calculates the relevant `rx` risk coordinates, combines them into a `RiskVector`, computes the Lyapunov residual `V_t`, and summarizes the state as a KER triad [24]. This entire dataset is then serialized into an ALN shard. A typical shard for a routing decision event would contain fields for the node ID, timestamps, geometry, the full `rx` vector, `V_t_before`, the KER scores, and the proposed command [24]. Critically, each row in this CSV-formatted shard is accompanied by an ALN_SPEC_HASH and a per-row hexstamp generated from a DID-signed specification, making the evidence packet immutable and its lineage undeniable [24].

Once an ALN shard is generated, it enters the purview of the Cyboquatic FOG router. This module is a pure Rust function that acts as the final arbiter of system behavior, standing between the controller and the legacy PLCs or drives [24]. Before a command is allowed to proceed to the actuators, it must pass through the router, which evaluates it against a battery of safety predicates derived directly from the shard's contents. These predicates form orthogonal planes of safety:

- **`tailwind_valid` (Energy Plane):** This predicate checks if the proposed workload aligns with the available energy surplus at the node, ensuring the system does not draw more power than it can sustainably generate or store.

- **`biosurface_ok` (Biodiversity Plane):** This predicate validates that the proposed action will not degrade the ecological surface risks, ensuring that operations do not harm sensitive habitats or exceed `r_biodiversity` corridors [24].
- **`hydraulic_ok` (Hydraulics Plane):** This checks that the command keeps all hydraulic parameters (pressure, flow, level) within their prescribed corridors, preventing over-pressurization or surcharge.
- **`lyapunov_ok` (Global V_t Plane):** This is the ultimate check, derived from the core safety spine. It verifies that the proposed action does not cause the Lyapunov residual `V_t` to increase. This ensures that the system's overall risk profile remains stable or improves, unifying all safety and ecological concerns under a single, powerful mathematical constraint [24].

The router returns one of three decisions: `Accept`, `Reroute`, or `Reject`. An `Accept` decision is only issued if *all* predicates pass. The admissibility clauses within the ALN schema enforce this, requiring that if a decision is `Accept`, then all corresponding `_pass` flags must be true and the condition $V_{t+1} \leq V_t$ must hold [24]. Nodes and controllers are programmed to refuse execution of any command that is not backed by an ALN shard satisfying these kernels. This creates a closed-loop system where every action is traceable, auditable, and guaranteed to be safe according to the immutable rules encoded in the ALN schemas and enforced by the FOG router. This pipeline is the cornerstone of trust, providing a demonstrable path from physical metrics through corridor validation to routing decisions, and ensuring that the 50-year continuity of the system is governed by cryptographic proof rather than ad-hoc tuning [24].

Strategic Implementation: Edge Languages and System-Level Synthesis

The successful implementation of the extended Cyboquatic framework hinges on the strategic and constrained use of edge languages—C++, Lua, and Kotlin/Android—to support the central Rust/ALN ecosafety kernel. These languages are not peers; they are subordinate tools, each playing a specific role in simulation fidelity, field configurability, and stakeholder engagement, respectively. Their integration must be meticulously managed through strict Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) and Foreign Function Interface (FFI) contracts to ensure they never compromise the invariants of the core safety logic. This section synthesizes the architectural requirements for these edge languages and outlines a phased rollout strategy for integrating the enhanced framework

with legacy industrial machinery, culminating in a fully realized, provably ecosafe system.

C++ is designated for tasks demanding high-performance, high-fidelity numerical computation, particularly for long-horizon simulations of decay, energy dynamics, and complex physics [24]. The primary use case is the creation of "numeric mirrors" that run parallel to the live system. For example, a C++ simulator could model the multi-year decay of a FlowVac substrate in a specific soil matrix, incorporating factors like moisture content, temperature, and microbial activity based on an Arrhenius-style model [24]. Another C++ module could simulate the long-term hydraulic performance of a pipeline network, factoring in progressive pipe roughness and biofouling. These simulators generate RFC-4180 ALNCSV shards containing predicted `rx` values and `V_t` trends over time [24]. The critical constraint is that the C++ code itself never defines corridor bands or makes actuation decisions. It is purely a forward-modeling engine whose output is consumed as data by the Rust components, which perform the actual validation against the established rules [24]. This division of labor leverages C++'s strengths in scientific computing while keeping the safety-critical logic in the safer, memory-protected environment of Rust.

Lua is selected for on-device scripting and configuration in resource-constrained controllers [24]. Its role is to allow for flexible, field-deployable diagnostics and data logging without requiring a full recompile of the main Rust application. A Lua script running on an edge device could be used to assemble local state data, call into FFI-provided Rust functions to compute `rx` and `V_t`, and format the results into ALN-compliant logs for transmission to a central fog node [24]. The API contract between Lua and Rust must be extremely restrictive: Lua scripts would have read-only access to sensor data and write-only access to logging functions. They would be incapable of invoking actuator commands or modifying any system state that could affect the `RiskVector`. This ensures that while operators have flexibility in configuring diagnostics in the field, they cannot accidentally or maliciously introduce unsafe behavior.

Kotlin/Android is tasked with creating stakeholder-facing applications for verification, visualization, and interaction [24]. These applications would not control the machinery but would serve as powerful diagnostic and reporting tools. Key functionalities would include visualizing KER scores and `rx` coordinate trends over time, displaying spatial heatmaps of risk across a network of nodes, and providing a user interface for submitting calibration data or workload proposals [24]. A critical feature would be the ability to locally verify the cryptographic hexstamps on ALN shards, giving stakeholders confidence that routing decisions were based on authentic, unaltered specifications. The Android app would

present complex data in an intuitive manner but would be cryptographically prevented from altering corridor bands or forcing actuation outside the Rust contracts [24].

To integrate this enhanced framework with existing industrial environments, a phased rollout pattern is recommended. The first phase would be a **passive monitor** mode, where the hybrid gateway sits between the PLC and actuators. It observes all commands and their outcomes, computes the `RiskVector` and `V_t`, and logs the results in ALN shards without ever blocking or derating any action. This allows the system to gather baseline data and calibrate corridor models in a live environment. The second phase transitions to **derate-only** mode. Here, if the `safestep_ok` check fails, the gateway does not block the command outright but instead modifies it to a safer, lower-power version (e.g., reducing motor speed) and passes it on. This allows the system to continue operating in a degraded but safe state while alerting operators to the underlying issue. The final phase is **hard gate** mode, where the FOG router operates as described, strictly enforcing the `safestep_ok` invariant and rejecting any command that would increase system risk. Throughout this process, all decisions are logged and hexstamped, creating a permanent, immutable record of the system's evolution and ensuring that the transition to full ecosafety is transparent and verifiable [24].

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